Different types of water

In many parts of Australia, water is often in short supply. There are different types, or grades, of water, and not all of them are safe to drink. **Drinking water** can be used for anything but should not be wasted. **Storm water** is the water that runs off after a heavy rainfall. It is safe to drink if carefully stored. **Grey water** is not safe for drinking and cannot be stored for long, but can be used to water gardens. **Black water** is dangerous and smelly until after it has been **treated**.

☞ **1** Fill in the table below by writing 'yes' or 'no' in the 'Can it be used?' column. Decide what each type of water can be used for and copy the correct use into the last column.

watering gardens or pastures

any use within water restrictions

drinking, washing or watering garden if safely stored

Type of water	Comes from	Can it be used?	Can be used for
Drinking water	taps, bottles or tanks		
Storm water	runs off roof after rainfall, into closed tank		
Grey water	washing machine, showers		
Black water	toilets or kitchen sink		No use before treatment – must go straight to sewerage system, septic tank or composting toilet

2 Choose the correct option from each pair in brackets.

Black water is [dangerous/safe] because it contains millions of [germs/vitamins].

Kitchen waste water has food particles, which could grow [bacteria/garden plants], so it goes to the sewage.

Grey water is safe for a while but grows germs if [used/stored], so needs to be used for watering within a day.

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